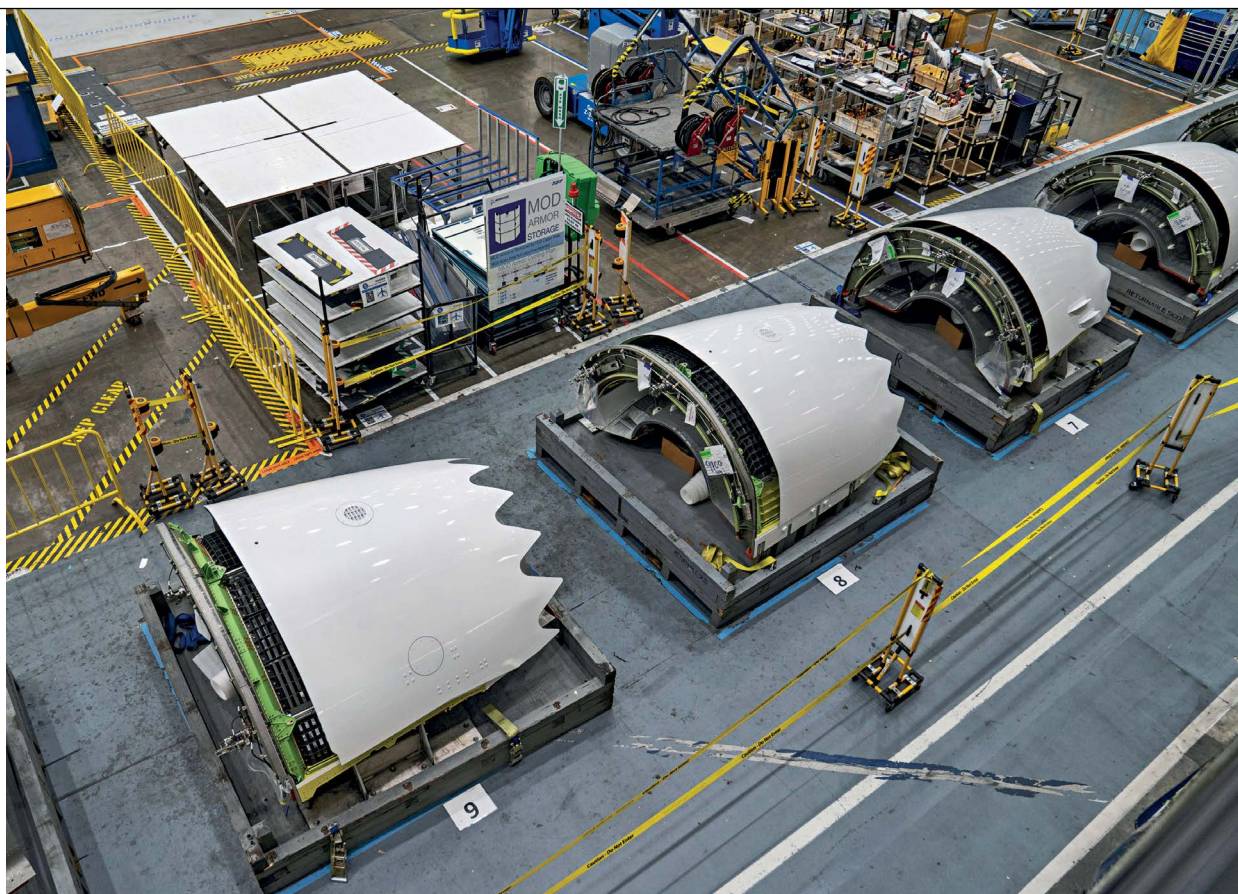




Assembly Line Boeing Co. 737 Max airplane engines at the company's manufacturing facility in Renton, Washington.

costs combined—at \$18–20 billion. Projected lease-related outflows alone are expected to reach approximately \$3.6 billion annually by 2040 as the order book converts to deliveries. These are not speculative projections. They are the contractual consequence of 2,026 aircraft already on order, almost all of which are being paid for in dollars.

When IndiGo disclosed its balance sheet as of June 2024, its capitalised operating lease liability stood at approximately \$5.4 billion—owed almost entirely in US dollars. In Q2 of FY26, IndiGo posted a net loss of ₹2,582 crore despite revenue growing by more than 10%. The airline's Chief Financial Officer Gaurav Negi, was explicit: "60% of the airline's costs

are in US dollars, including fuel and maintenance."

A rupee depreciation of just 1.7% in that single quarter produced a foreign exchange loss amounting to ₹2,892 crore, roughly \$340 million. ICRA's 2024 aviation industry report captured the structural exposure: "Approximately 35–50% of total airline operating expenses are denominated in dollar terms, making airlines highly vulnerable to currency depreciation."

AIRPORTS & BOARDING GATES

Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL), which operates seven of India's major airports, has made a deliberate effort against the grain. "Adani Airports is committed to using Made in India technology

INDIAN COMMERCIAL AIRCRAFT: HAL'S HINDUSTAN 228

19 SEATS

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